João Azevedo

Mobile & Full-Stack Engineer | Portugal (UTC+0) | Remote, EU/UK time zones
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Summary

MSc in Computer Science and Engineering from Instituto Superior Técnico (final grade 15/20, thesis 16/20). Built and shipped GYM RPG solo, a gamified fitness app on Google Play and the App Store with 1,447 monthly active users, a Flutter client, a Supabase/Postgres backend and in-app subscriptions. Thesis on LLM-driven dialogue systems, built as a Flutter desktop application and evaluated in a user study. Seeking a remote mobile or full-stack role on a team with regular code review and senior mentorship.

Experience

Founder & Lead Engineer, GYM RPG Feb 2026 – present
iOS and Android app (Flutter, Supabase) *Remote, Portugal*

- Shipped a cross-platform Flutter app solo. Monthly active users grew from 56 (Apr) to 1,447 (Oct 2026) across 7+ countries; 5.0 rating on Google Play.
- Designed the Supabase backend: Postgres with row-level security, 360+ versioned SQL migrations and 60+ Deno/TypeScript edge functions. Rewards, purchases and combat resolve server-side so the untrusted client cannot forge results.
- Integrated RevenueCat subscriptions with webhook-driven entitlement sync; 33 subscribers in 90 days.
- Built social features (friends, parties, chat, co-op boss fights), push notifications (FCM) and scheduled streak and re-engagement jobs.
- Localized into 9 languages and instrumented onboarding and paywall funnels with PostHog.
- Automated releases with Fastlane and GitHub Actions (145+ builds shipped); Riverpod state management; 130+ test files (unit, widget, backend).
- Handled Apple App Review and Google Play policy cycles, including rejections and metadata fixes.

Education

MSc Computer Science and Engineering (MEIC-A) 2024 – 2026
Instituto Superior Técnico, Universidade de Lisboa | Final grade: 15/20 *Lisbon*

- Thesis (16/20): *Enhancing Visual Novel Storytelling through Personality-Based Dialogue Systems Powered by Large Language Models*. Supervisor: Prof. Carlos Martinho.
- Designed a 2D emotion-wheel dialogue interface (16 emotions on a valence/arousal circumplex). An LLM writes in-character lines at authoring time from the NPC's Big Five personality, relationships and narrative context, and the designer reviews every line.
- Built it as a dual-mode Flutter desktop app (authoring tool and playable engine, Windows/Linux) with a configurable cloud or local LLM backend.
- Evaluated in an 8-participant task-based study: editor usability SUS mean 77.5 (median 82.5, 6 of 8 above the 68 threshold); player experience UEQ mean +1.49, positive on all six scales.

BSc Computer Science and Engineering (LEIC-A) 2019 – 2024
Instituto Superior Técnico, Universidade de Lisboa *Lisbon*

Skills

Languages	Dart, TypeScript, SQL; working knowledge of Python, C/C++, Java, C#
Mobile	Flutter, Riverpod, iOS and Android release processes, push notifications, in-app purchases, localization
Backend	Supabase (Postgres, RLS, Auth, Edge Functions), Deno, REST/RPC design, webhooks, migrations
Tools	Git, GitHub Actions, Fastlane, PostHog, RevenueCat, Firebase, Docker
Other	LLM integration and prompt design, user studies (SUS, UEQ), Unity, Godot, Ren'Py

Projects

Visual novel emotion-wheel editor (thesis prototype) – github.com/joaochartersazevedo/flutterTese. Flutter desktop editor and engine with LLM-generated dialogue and a 16-emotion circumplex model.

Languages

Portuguese (native), English (fluent, full professional working proficiency).